Project Scope Statement

What is in, what is out, and how scope is controlled

Document	02 - Project Scope
Project	AI Customer Support Platform (fictional company: Kestrel Commerce Ltd.)
Prepared by	Project Manager (portfolio author) - self-directed simulation
Status	Simulated baseline v1.0
Project window	5 Jan - 13 Mar 2026 (simulated project window)

SIMULATED PROJECT - Self-directed portfolio case study. Not professional experience, not client work, not employment. All people, figures and outcomes are fictional.

1. Project scope and product scope

	Definition
Project scope (the work)	Initiate, plan, specify, design, build, test, release and close a pilot-ready AI customer support platform in 10 weeks using five Scrum sprints. Includes requirements, UX, development, AI evaluation, security and privacy controls, UAT, deployment, training and closure (see WBS).
Product scope (the product)	A web platform with: AI chat answering from a company knowledge base with citations and a safe fallback; escalation to human agents; an admin interface for knowledge-base content and users; conversation history; basic analytics; authentication with four roles; and security and privacy controls.

2. In scope

Area	Included in the MVP	Features
Customer experience	Email-code sign-in; chat window with sources and AI label; answer feedback; 30-day conversation history; 'Talk to a person'	F02, F05, F06, F07
AI assistant	Ingestion and indexing of published articles; grounded answers with citations; confidence threshold and fallback; out-of-scope refusal; PII redaction; golden-set evaluation	F04
Human handover	Escalation queue, claim, transcript, reply, resolve, customer notification (in-chat and email)	F08
Knowledge base admin	Create, edit, publish, unpublish; bulk import (CSV/Markdown); content audit before launch	F03
Analytics	Event tracking; manager dashboard for volume, deflection, escalation, feedback and fallback topics	F09
Security and privacy	Roles and permissions, rate limiting, validation, secrets, scans, 90-day retention, deletion on request, audit log (Should)	F02, F10, F11
Delivery	Environments, CI/CD, monitoring, load test, UAT, pilot release, guides, training, closure	F01, F12, F13

3. Out of scope

Item	Why it is out	Where it goes
Helpdesk / CRM integration	Integration risk and effort exceed 10 weeks	Post-MVP backlog (US-33, Won't)
Languages other than English	Needs translated content and evaluation sets (CR-001 assessed)	Post-MVP backlog (US-34, Won't)
Native mobile app, voice, social channels	Responsive web chat is sufficient for the pilot	Post-MVP backlog (US-35, Won't)
AI actions on accounts (refunds, plan changes)	Legal, security and fraud risk; humans handle these	Not planned
Single sign-on with merchant portal	Dependency on another team's roadmap	Future option
Advanced analytics / BI exports	Basic dashboard meets objectives	Future option
Fine-tuning or training custom models	Retrieval from approved content is simpler, cheaper and easier to audit	Not planned
Rollout beyond the pilot cohort	Decision after pilot results	Follow-on project

4. MVP summary and MoSCoW

The baseline contains 30 stories worth 161 story points: 147 points (26 stories) are Must Have and 14 points (4 stories) are Should Have. Should Have stories (bulk import, answer feedback, audit logging, guides and training) are the planned de-scope buffer. Could Have and Won't Have items are listed in the Project Brief and the backlog.

5. Scope boundaries

Dimension	Boundary
Users	Pilot cohort of merchants; 14 agents; 1 manager; admins (Knowledge & Content Lead and 1 deputy).
Channels	Web chat only (desktop and mobile browsers, 360 px and up).
Language	English.
Content	Published knowledge-base articles only; no live data from merchant accounts.
Data	Conversations retained 90 days; customers see 30 days; no message text in analytics events.
Environments	Dev, staging, production in one cloud region.
Systems	Standalone platform; external services limited to the LLM/embedding API and an email provider.

6. Assumptions and constraints

Scope assumptions

- About 280 cleaned articles are enough to cover the most frequent ticket categories.
- Merchants accept signing in with an email code instead of a password.
- Support SMEs validate reference answers for the golden set within the sprint.
- LLM provider terms are confirmed before real customer data is used (AIR-06).

Scope constraints

- 10 weeks, 61 person-weeks, 5,500 USD non-labour budget.
- AI answers only from published content; PII redacted before LLM calls.
- Must-Have scope changes need Sponsor approval.

7. How the PM controls scope

Scope-control approach

1 Baseline: scope, requirements and backlog are baselined at M2 (16 Jan); the Won't-Have list is published so exclusions are visible.

2. One door in: every request goes to the Product Owner, is logged and assessed; nobody adds work directly to a sprint.
3. Assess impact: PM and tech leads estimate effort, schedule, cost, risk and quality impact within 2 business days (Change Request form).
4. Decide using the thresholds below; record the decision in the change log and tell the requester why.
5. Trade, do not stack: new Must-Have work is accepted only if equal work leaves the sprint or the Sponsor extends time or budget.
6. Change only at sprint boundaries unless a defect or compliance issue demands otherwise.

Change type	Decision maker	Time limit
Re-ordering stories inside a sprint, no scope change	PM with Product Owner	Same day
Add, defer or remove a Should/Could story	Product Owner and PM (Sponsor informed)	2 business days
Add or remove a Must-Have story or change an acceptance criterion materially	Sponsor on Product Owner recommendation	Next sprint review
Budget above +10% or schedule above +3 working days	Sponsor / steering	Next sprint review
Security or compliance fix	Security & Privacy Officer with PM	Immediate; reported at review

De-scope order if capacity is lost

1. US-08 Audit logging deferred to post-MVP.
2. US-30 Guides reduced to a one-page quick reference plus a 30-minute walkthrough.
3. US-17 Feedback comment field dropped (thumbs only).
4. US-10 Bulk-import screen dropped (seed-load script and single-article editor remain).
5. Escalate to the Sponsor: smaller pilot (top 10 content categories) or a moved Go/No-Go. Must-Have stories are never silently cut.

Early-warning signs of scope creep

- More than two unplanned requests per sprint; requests phrased as 'small tweaks' to Must-Have acceptance criteria.
- Stakeholders asking for 100% accuracy or new channels in sprint reviews (risk R15 and R08).
- Velocity falling while story count rises.

Worked example: CR-001 (Spanish language support) was assessed and deferred - see 21_Change_Request.pdf.